

What footage to record — and why each rule needs it

Every rule below is **already built and tested**. What it is missing is footage in which the offence is physically visible. This is a filming task, not a coding task — you can do all of it with a phone in under an hour.

Send me the files and I will run them and produce the evidence images.

Ground rules for every clip

Rule	Why
Landscape , not portrait	Matches a real camera and fills the slide
1080p , 30 fps	Higher just costs decode time; lower loses plates
Phone completely still — wall, ledge, bottle, books	A moving camera makes "is this vehicle stationary?" unanswerable
At least 60 seconds	Several rules need 20+ seconds of continuous observation
Daylight, plate visible	OCR needs roughly 40+ pixels of plate width
Don't zoom mid-clip	Zooming invalidates the geometry

1. Illegal Parking — highest value, easiest to get

This is the one your crossing photo could not prove. Parking means a vehicle that stays put. The scooter in that photo had been moving seconds earlier, so the system correctly refused to call it parked.

Shot: phone propped **completely still** on a wall, aimed at a parked car or motorcycle by a kerb. Let it run **90 seconds**. The vehicle must never move, and ideally other traffic drives past in the same frame.

Why it will fire: the rule needs 20 seconds stationary, 12+ observations, and the vehicle never seen moving. Passing traffic in shot is a bonus — it proves the system tells parked from moving in one frame.

■ **You need one clip. Ninety seconds. That is the whole task.**

2. Mobile Phone Use

Shot: sit in a **parked** car. Phone on the dashboard or held by a passenger,

filming the driver from the front-right, from about chest height. Driver holds a phone **clearly visible against a light background**, not down in their lap. 30 seconds.

Why: the phone must be detected as a distinct object at 0.50 confidence. It needs to be seen, not implied by posture.

■ ■ **Film only in a stationary car.** Never while anyone is driving.

3. No Seatbelt — needs one more thing first

Shot: same setup as above. Two takes, 30 seconds each — one belted, one not. The chest and the diagonal strap must both be in frame.

■ ■ **But this rule will still stay off**, and you should know why before you film. Our models/seatbelt.pt is broken: it reports "no seatbelt" at 100% confidence for a driver *wearing* a belt and for a photo of an empty motorway. I disabled it deliberately.

Filming this is only worth it if we also source a working seatbelt **detection** model (not a classifier). Do the other clips first.

4. Red Light Jump

Shot: a signalised junction, phone still on a wall or railing. You must be able to see **both** the signal head **and** the stop line for the lane facing you. Film 2–3 full signal cycles, about 3 minutes.

Then tell me: which signal head in frame controls the lane nearest the camera. That is the one thing the system cannot work out on its own, and it is why I advised against demoing red light — a junction has four or five heads facing different directions, and reading the wrong one fines a stopped car.

5. Over Speeding on a Sri Lankan road

Already demonstrated on two calibrated cameras, so this is optional polish — but a *local* speeding clip would be much stronger than foreign highway footage.

Shot: a straight road from a footbridge or upper floor, camera still, 2 minutes. **Then measure one thing on the ground:** the real-world length and width of a marked road section in the shot — for example the distance between two lamp posts, in metres. Without that measurement no speed can be shown.

6. Wrong Way

Shot: a one-way street or a divided carriageway, camera still, 2 minutes.

Tell me which direction is legal. You do not need an actual offender — the value is showing that lawful traffic is correctly *not* flagged.

Priority if you only have one hour

1. ■ **Illegal parking** (90 s) — highest value, easiest, fills a real gap
2. ■ **Mobile phone use** (30 s, parked car) — fills a second gap
3. ■ **Local speeding clip** + the ground measurement — replaces foreign footage

Red light and seatbelt are **not** worth your time before tomorrow. Red light needs junction calibration you cannot do in an evening, and seatbelt is blocked on a model, not on footage.